ACTIVITY 070

Tune the Phrase Ending

Pitch & Listening

6 minutes / Last two bars of a song.

Stabilize a closing note within its musical context.

LAST NOTE

Hear the target

→

LAST TWO WORDS

Keep the approach

→

FULL ENDING

Sing it in context

Build the ending backwards in useful units, then test it in the whole phrase.

1. Hear and sing the final note in a comfortable key; notice its place in the phrase.
2. Sing backward from the ending in small units: last word, last two words, then the full closing line.
3. Compare the final pitch to a reference after the complete phrase rather than stopping early to correct it.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The last note is secure when approached through its actual melody.

COMMON TRAP

Securing an isolated final note but never its approach.

MAKE IT WORK

Shorten the phrase and use a slower tempo or octave alternative.